

# A Star Fleet Battles™ Rule Proposal

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Optimized for defense, this skid is a specialized redesign of the General Skid (R1.68A). It contains an APR box, two Phaser-3s, two batteries and a tractor beam. The phasers have a 360-degree firing arc. The skid increases the BPV of the freighter by six and adds a single crew unit (to operate and maintain the systems). No empire ever built a version of this equipped with a Phaser-G, not even the Hydrans.

Some variants of this skid replaced one of the phasers with an ADD rack (E5.0). Until Y175, these were almost exclusively six round racks (E5.51) and did not have reloads, which creates an exception to (E5.71); a ship using this skid could nevertheless carry reloads as an explicit part of its cargo. By the end of Y175, most of these were upgraded to 12 round racks (E5.52) that would typically include a single reload, which again was an exception to (E5.71); and, more ADDs could be carried as cargo.

Other variants replaced each phaser with an ADD rack, but they were quite rare, as the phasers were a more-versatile weapon, and finding ammunition was not always easy, especially on the frontier.

In one case, a skid of this type retained the phasers but replaced the tractor beam with an ADD. This increased the cost to seven BPV, and appears to have been done because the parts for the (cheaper) tractor beam were simply not available at the time. Particularly on newly-established colony worlds, one used what was at hand.

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